with the words 'never count this guy out'. At risk of repeating myself over and over again, for the umpteenth time in these pages, we were privileged to play for such a captain.

Our form was improving again, and we produced some excellent cricket to win the ODI series 4–1, including a famous win in the opening ODI: Pakistan had needed only 19 runs from 55 balls to win, with six wickets left, but we had fought back, grabbed wicket after wicket and, amazingly, won by two runs.

Such drama enthused and excited everyone, and we advanced to sweep the T20 series 2–0 in the UAE before both teams flew to South Africa and continued what was starting to feel like an endless series of limited-overs matches, with two more T20 matches (1–1) and three more ODIs (1–2).

After 14 matches against Pakistan, we were relieved when India arrived to play three ODIs and two Test matches around Christmas, if only because they would provide fresh opposition. In fact, they didn't provide much opposition at all in the one-day internationals. We won comfortably in Johannesburg when 20-year-old Quinton de Kock helped us to score 358 in 50 overs, and we won in Durban with Quinton scoring another century.

The youngster scored a third century in a row in the third ODI at Centurion, and I also reached three figures as we took our total to 301, but the match was washed out by torrential rain.

MS Dhoni's side seemed to be struggling, but they remained a hugely talented group of cricketers and they raised their level of performance to play a full part in a thrilling first Test ...

India win the toss and bat at the Wanderers, and Virat Kohli shows discipline and skill to score a century against a dangerous attack in difficult conditions, helping his side to 280 in their first innings. In reply, Graeme and Hashim guide us to 130 for one, but we collapse to 146 for six and struggle to 244 all out.